

COMPOSITION MODEL · PHASE 2C — THE WATERMARK ISLAND

Slides as Islands

A slide is a sea plus a fixed set of berths. The masthead band holds the title and a populated bay; the footer now carries a section progress rail. Additive, palette-blind, across every render path.

SECTION 01

The Lift

The masthead is now a band, not the top of a flow.

CONFIDENTIAL

The **islands** modifier wraps the eyebrow and title into a dedicated masthead band with a hairline rule and a reserved right bay. Everything below the rule is the slide body — a clean, separately-addressable region. Authoring is unchanged.

The band composes with components untouched.

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Body stays a section child

Cards, lists, charts, and tables remain direct children of the section, so every `section.X > ...` selector keeps matching.

Only the masthead moves

The eyebrow and first heading lift into the band; the rest is left exactly where the author put it.

One opt-in token

Add `islands` to any content layout. Incompatible only with `math` and `compare-code`.

SECTION 02

The Bay

EVIDENCE · SAME ENGINE, THREE PATHS

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The lift is identical across every render path.

MARP-CLI, THE EMULATOR, AND THE RUNTIME DISPATCH ONE REGISTRY-WIRED TRANSFORM.

3

RENDER PATHS

1

OPT-IN TOKEN

0

COMPONENTS BROKEN

The bay docks the meta and status islands.

WIP

KEY INSIGHT

Key insight: the **meta:** line and a status chip (this slide is **wip**) now ride the bay the masthead reserved in Phase 1.

SECTION 03

Orientation

The footer now orients the audience.

The progress island reads the deck's **divider** slides as sections and stamps a dot-rail into the footer centre of every **islands** slide — current section elongated and accented, labelled with the divider title. The watermark island echoes the section number behind this text.

The five islands have landed.

*Next · Phase 4 — the concrete stage
wrapper*

*Inspect this deck against the model in
engineering/decisions/2026-06-11-
islands.md.*